The Money God

Moon Ghost

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Preface

I was raised in a world that talked about money constantly and understood it not at all.

We were told it was a neutral tool, a convenient medium of exchange, a way to keep score in the great game of life. We were told that wanting it was natural, that accumulating it was wise, that lacking it was a personal failure. We were told that the economy was a machine, that growth was always good, that the market was the fairest arbiter of value.

And all of this was delivered in a tone so flat, so matter-of-fact, that it took me decades to notice a fundamental oddity. The same thing that was supposedly just a practical convenience was also the thing for which we destroyed forests, burned fossil fuels, abandoned communities, worked ourselves into illness, and went to war. The same thing that was just a tool was also the thing whose absence could make a person feel worthless, and whose presence could make a person feel chosen.

A mere tool does not have this power. A mere tool does not command worship. A mere tool does not reorganize entire civilizations around its needs, demand sacrifices of the vulnerable, and convince the sacrificers that they are being virtuous.

I came to see that money, as it functions in our world, is not a neutral instrument. It is a god. It is a spiritual technology that has colonized human consciousness more thoroughly than any army ever colonized a territory. And the project of colonization—the five-hundred-year campaign of extraction, enslavement, and cultural erasure that Europe inflicted on the world—was not primarily about gold or sugar or land. It was about installing this god in every human mind, making the worship of accumulation feel like the natural order of things.

This book is the story of that god. Where it came from. How it operates. What it has done to us. And how we might begin to practice a different relationship to the material world—one rooted in reciprocity, sufficiency, and care rather than extraction, hoarding, and control.

It is not a book about personal finance. It is not a book about policy reform. It is a book about the architecture of our souls, and the quiet, patient work of reclaiming them.

Introduction: The God in Your Pocket

Look at a dollar bill. Not the number, not what it can buy. Just the object itself. A piece of linen-cotton blend, printed with symbols: a pyramid, an eye, a dead statesman, words in Latin. You have handled thousands of these. You have worked for them, worried about them, dreamed about them. You have felt the flush of relief when they arrive and the clench of anxiety when they leave.

But have you ever asked what this object actually is?

It is not wealth. Wealth is fertile soil, clean water, skilled hands, a healthy child, a forest that regenerates, a community that cares for its elders. The dollar bill is a promise, and a peculiar kind of promise at that. It promises that you can exchange it for real things later. But the promise is backed by nothing except the agreement of everyone else to honor it. If that agreement ever collapses—if enough people stop believing—the paper is just paper.

Money is a shared hallucination. It is the most successful shared hallucination in human history. And like any successful religion, it has its priesthood, its temples, its orthodoxy, and its heretics.

This book argues that the global economic order is best understood not as a system of rational exchange but as a spiritual regime. It worships a god—let us call it Mammon, or the Money God—who demands perpetual growth, treats the living world as a resource, reduces human worth to a number, and punishes with poverty and exclusion those who will not or cannot comply.

The worship of this god did not emerge naturally. It was installed, over centuries, through a campaign of spiritual conquest that rode alongside the military and political conquest of colonization. The cross and the ledger book traveled together. The mission and the market were two arms of the same project: to replace the indigenous gods of belonging, reciprocity, and sufficiency with the universal god of accumulation.

This is not a metaphor. This is the most accurate description we have of what actually happened.

The people who first inhabited the Americas, Africa, and much of Asia did not organize their economic lives around private property, endless growth, and atomized self-interest. They organized them around kinship, gift, potlatch, commons, and a deep sense that the land is a relative, not a resource. These were not primitive precursors to capitalism. They were fully developed alternative theologies of matter—and they were deliberately, violently suppressed. The Money God cannot tolerate competition. It must convert or destroy.

The tragedy of our moment is that the Money God is consuming itself. The infinite growth it requires is impossible on a finite planet. The satisfaction it promises never arrives, because its engine runs on manufactured scarcity and perpetual discontent. The communities it dissolves—the extended families, the mutual aid networks, the local knowledge systems—are the very things that might have allowed us to navigate the coming crises with resilience and care. We have traded our souls for a dopamine loop, and the loop is running out of fuel.

But the old gods are not dead. The indigenous theologies of matter, suppressed but never extinguished, are re-emerging in movements for food sovereignty, land back, cooperative economics, universal basic services, and the re-commoning of resources. The core insight of this book is that we do not need to invent a new economics from scratch. We need to remember what was known before the conquest, and to adapt that memory to the conditions of a globally connected world.

The compass from the first book—feedback, curiosity, protection—applies here with particular force. A healthy economy is one where the consequences of economic action flow back to those who caused them. A curious economy explores diverse forms of exchange, ownership, and care rather than imposing a single template. A protective economy treats the vulnerable—the poor, the sick, the displaced, the non-human—as the most reliable sensors of systemic health. The Money God's economy fails all three tests. It has built a world where the rich are insulated from the damage they cause, where alternatives are ridiculed or criminalized, and where the canary's song is drowned out by the din of commerce.

This book is a diagnostic and a recovery manual. It names the god, traces its history, and maps the pathways of withdrawal. It offers no single blueprint—that would be the static mind's demand resurfacing—but it offers a direction. Toward local sovereignty. Toward circular economies. Toward a re-embedding of money in relationships of care, so that it becomes a servant rather than a master.

You hold in your hands an invitation to exorcism. Not the dramatic kind, with shouting and smoke. The quiet kind, where you begin to see the idol for what it is, and your grip on it loosens, and you find that your hands, now free, can hold something more alive.

Chapter 1: The Coffee You Don't Taste

Hold a cup of coffee in your mind. Not the idea of coffee, but the physical object. The warmth through the ceramic. The smell, faintly acidic, faintly sweet. The first bitter sip that has become, for so many of us, the ritual that marks the start of consciousness.

Now ask yourself: *What am I actually holding?*

You are holding a bean that was grown in soil you have never touched, by hands you have never shaken, in a country you may not be able to find on a map. That bean was picked, processed, shipped across an ocean, roasted, ground, and brewed by a chain of human beings so long that you could not trace it if you tried. Each of those human beings needed to eat, needed shelter, hoped for something for their children. Each of them received a fraction of what you paid for the cup. The farmer received the smallest fraction. The barista received a bit more. The shareholders of the coffee chain received the largest fraction, and many of them have never touched a coffee bean in their lives.

Now ask a harder question: *What don't I know about this cup?*

You do not know whether the farmer's children can afford school. You do not know whether the plantation displaced a forest, whether the pesticides sickened a village, whether the shipping containers burned fuel that is now acidifying the ocean. You do not know whether the barista who served you is working a second job to pay rent, whether they have health insurance, whether their smile was genuine or a performance required by a manager trained to enforce pleasantness.

You do not know any of this. And you are not supposed to know. The coffee is designed to arrive in your hand as a finished object, clean and warm and severed from its history. This severing is the Money God's primary sacrament.

The Stripping of Relationship

Every object you buy was once embedded in a web of relationships. There was soil and rain and seed and labor and transport and trade and negotiation and craft. Before the Money God completed its colonization of our minds, those relationships were visible. The person who made your shoes lived in your village. The person who grew your food was your neighbor, or your cousin, or yourself. The act of exchange was also an act of recognition. You knew, at least roughly, what it cost to produce the thing you were receiving, and you knew whom it cost.

The Money God's great innovation was to strip the relationship from the object. To make the coffee a commodity rather than a gift, a transaction rather than a bond. The commodity is defined by its price, not its provenance. It arrives from nowhere, and the money you pay for it disappears into nowhere. The loop is severed at both ends. You do not feel the consequences of your purchase in the body of the farmer. The farmer does not receive your gratitude, or your complaint, or your recognition. The two of you are connected by a thing but separated by a system that has been carefully engineered to prevent that connection from becoming a relationship.

This is not an accident of complexity. It is the architecture of the Money God's temple. The long supply chain, the multiple layers of intermediaries, the abstraction of value into price—these are the walls and altars of a religion that cannot tolerate direct encounter between producer and consumer, because direct encounter might spark recognition, and recognition might spark solidarity, and solidarity might spark a demand for something other than the endless extraction of profit.

The Fog of Money

The fog in this book is not the general fog of static thinking. It is something more specific. It is the fog that settles over every object you buy, every bill you pay, every investment you hold, obscuring the chain of consequences that connects your economic choices to the lives of other people and the health of the planet.

You buy a cheap shirt. The fog hides the factory where it was sewn, the woman who sewed it, the wage she was paid, the hours she stood, the dormitory where she sleeps, the fire exit that was locked. You put money in a pension fund. The fog hides the fossil fuel companies in the portfolio, the pipelines, the spills, the communities displaced, the decades of denial funded by your retirement savings. You pay your taxes. The fog hides the bombs bought with a portion of them, the children in the village, the hospital with no roof, the grief that will never appear on a balance sheet.

The fog is not complete ignorance. It is selective ignorance. You are given a rich stream of information about some things—the price, the brand, the features, the status signal—and a near-total silence about others. This selectivity is not random. It is structured to allow the flows of money to continue uninterrupted by the flows of feeling that might complicate them.

The Money God's First Commandment

Every religion has its first and greatest commandment. For the Money God, it is this: **Transactions shall not mature into relationships.**

A transaction is an exchange that terminates. You pay, you receive, the interaction is over. No ongoing obligation. No memory. No debt of gratitude or reciprocity. The coffee is drunk, the cup is discarded, the moment passes into oblivion. Tomorrow you will repeat the ritual with an identical cup, and the farmer will still be poor, and the planet will still be warming, and none of this will trouble your morning because the transaction has been sealed off from consequence.

A relationship is an exchange that continues. It creates obligations, expectations, mutual knowledge. If you knew the farmer—if you had visited their farm, met their children, seen the soil and the shade trees—your purchase would feel different. You might pay more willingly, because you would understand the cost. You might buy less frequently, because you would feel the weight of each purchase. You might refuse to participate in a system that kept the farmer poor despite your connection. The coffee would no longer be a commodity. It would be a bond.

The Money God cannot permit this. Bonds slow down the circulation of money, because bonds introduce considerations other than price. Loyalty. Fairness. Care. Sustainability. These are inefficiencies in the theology of the market. The money must flow without friction, and friction comes from relationship. So the system is designed to prevent relationship from forming, or to break it wherever it accidentally appears.

The Gift of Proximity

There is a counter-practice, ancient and now countercultural, that you can begin to experiment with. It is the deliberate shortening of the distance between your economic choices and their consequences.

You can do this in one small domain. Not everything at once. Pick one thing you buy regularly. Coffee, bread, vegetables, clothing. Trace it. Ask: *Where did this come from? Who made it? Under what conditions? What happens to the waste it produces?* You will not get perfect answers. The fog is thick. But the act of asking is itself a restoration of the loop. You are refusing to let the commodity remain a ghost.

Then, if you can, take one step toward relationship. Buy from a farmer at a market. Learn their name. Ask them one question about the work. If you cannot afford that, and many cannot, simply hold the knowledge in your mind as you make the purchase. You are saying to the Money God, quietly: *I know you want this transaction to be invisible. I am making it visible.*

This is not a solution to global poverty. It is a practice of reconnection. The fog is maintained by billions of severed loops. Each loop you restore in your own life—each connection you make visible—is a crack in the Money God's temple. The cracks accumulate. The light enters. And the god, which seemed so omnipotent when it was worshiped by everyone in the room, begins to look like what it always was: a shared agreement, and one that can be withdrawn.

Chapter 2: The First Conquest

The year is 1455. Pope Nicholas V issues a papal bull called *Romanus Pontifex*. The document is written in Latin, the language of power, and it is addressed to the King of Portugal. It grants him the right to invade, capture, and enslave any "Saracens and pagans" he encounters in his explorations down the coast of Africa. Their lands, their goods, their bodies are declared available for Christian appropriation.

This is not framed as theft. It is framed as charity. The bull speaks of bringing the light of Christ to those who dwell in darkness. The sword and the cross are intertwined. The salvation of souls is the stated purpose. The seizure of everything else is the unstated consequence.

A few decades later, in 1493, Pope Alexander VI issues *Inter Caetera*, extending the same logic to the Americas. A line is drawn down the Atlantic Ocean. Everything west of it, and all the peoples dwelling there, are granted to Spain. The justification is the same: saving souls. The effect is the same: taking lands, extracting wealth, destroying worlds.

These documents are the founding charters of the Money God's global expansion. And they contain, in embryo, the entire logic of what will follow.

The Doctrine of Discovery

The Doctrine of Discovery, as these principles came to be called, rests on an assumption so deep it was rarely stated aloud: that non-Christian peoples had no true ownership of the land they inhabited. They might live on it, cultivate it, bury their ancestors in it, sing songs about it, and fight to defend it, but none of this constituted *property* in the European sense. Property required a particular relationship: one of individual, alienable ownership, enforced by a state and recognized by law. Indigenous peoples had relationship to land; they did not have title. And without title, they were invisible to the legal order that was sweeping across the globe.

This was not a minor legal technicality. It was a metaphysical judgment. The indigenous ways of relating to land—as kin, as mother, as a web of reciprocal obligation—were declared not merely different but null. They did not count. They were not real. The land was *terra nullius*, empty, waiting for the true owners to arrive and claim it.

And claim it they did. Spain took the Caribbean, Mexico, Peru. Portugal took Brazil. England, France, and the Netherlands followed. Each brought soldiers and priests. Each brought a flag and a cross. Each brought, crucially, the legal and economic infrastructure of property: deeds, surveys, courts, taxes, the entire apparatus that transforms a living landscape into a grid of owned parcels.

The land, once property, could be bought and sold. It could be leveraged as collateral for loans. It could be stripped of its forests, mined for its minerals, plowed for its soil, and then sold again, often to someone who had never set foot on it. The land became capital. And capital, unlike land, has no memory. It does not recognize ancestors. It does not require ceremony or reciprocity. It requires only a rate of return.

The Killing of the Potlatch

The Money God did not merely take land. It actively suppressed the economic theologies that predated its arrival, because they constituted a rival worship.

Consider the potlatch. Among the Indigenous nations of the Pacific Northwest—the Kwakwaka'wakw, the Haida, the Tlingit, and many others—the potlatch was the central economic and ceremonial institution. A chief or a clan would host a great gathering, feeding hundreds of guests, performing dances and songs, and then distributing gifts: blankets, copper shields, food, canoes. The more one gave away, the higher one's status became. Wealth was not measured by accumulation but by the scale and splendor of its distribution.

This was not mere generosity. It was a sophisticated system of social accounting, recordkeeping, and mutual obligation. The gifts were witnessed. The debts were remembered. The circulation of goods through the community created a dense web of reciprocal ties that provided for everyone and ensured that no individual or family could accumulate vastly more than others without being expected to give it away. The potlatch was an economic theology of abundance through circulation, not accumulation.

The Canadian government, with the full support of missionaries, outlawed the potlatch in 1885. The ban remained in force until 1951. For sixty-six years, hosting a potlatch was a criminal offense. People were arrested. Regalia was confiscated and sent to museums. Ceremonies went underground, performed in secret, passed down in whispers.

Why? The official justification was that the potlatch was wasteful, primitive, and an obstacle to the civilizing mission. The real reason was more interesting. The potlatch was a direct threat to the Money God. You cannot accumulate capital indefinitely in a society where the highest status is achieved by giving everything away. You cannot create a docile workforce when the primary economic identity is not the individual worker but the extended kin group, with its collective obligations and its resistance to atomization. You cannot convince people that their worth is measured by their bank account when the culture has an entirely different metric, one that is visible, ceremonial, and deeply satisfying.

The potlatch had to die so that the market could live. The alternative theology of matter had to be suppressed so that the universal theology of accumulation could be installed. This was not a side effect of colonization. It was its central purpose.

The Commons and the Enclosure

The same logic operated within Europe itself, centuries before the conquest of the Americas. The commons—the lands, forests, and waterways that were held collectively by villages—were the economic basis of ordinary life for most of the medieval and early modern periods. Peasants grazed their animals on common pasture, gathered firewood from common woods, fished in common streams. The commons were not owned by anyone in particular, and they were essential to everyone's survival.

Beginning in England in the sixteenth century and accelerating through the eighteenth and nineteenth, the commons were systematically enclosed. Landlords fenced them off, converted them to private property, and often converted them to sheep pasture, because wool was more profitable than peasant subsistence. The peasants were driven off the land, into the cities, into the factories, into the wage labor that would become the foundation of industrial capitalism.

The enclosure of the commons was justified by economic efficiency. The land would be more productive in private hands, it was argued. The peasants would find better opportunities in the towns. What was lost was not efficiency. What was lost was a way of life based on shared access, mutual obligation, and the understanding that certain resources are not commodities but the common inheritance of a community.

The Money God cannot abide a commons. A commons is a space where the logic of accumulation does not rule, where resources are held in trust rather than exploited for profit, where the question is not "What is this worth?" but "Who needs this, and how shall we share it?" The enclosure of the commons, like the suppression of the potlatch, was an act of spiritual warfare. It was the elimination of an alternative economic theology, a clearing of the ground for the universal reign of private property.

The Continuity

The Doctrine of Discovery, the potlatch ban, the enclosure of the commons—these are not separate events. They are consecutive campaigns in the same long war. The war is not between nations or civilizations. It is between two fundamentally different ways of relating to the material world.

One way sees the world as alive, relational, and sacred. It treats the land as kin, the gift as the highest form of exchange, and the community as the unit of survival and meaning. It measures wealth by the health of the relationships that sustain life.

The other way sees the world as dead, measurable, and ownable. It treats the land as resource, the transaction as the highest form of exchange, and the individual as the unit of survival and meaning. It measures wealth by the accumulation of tokens that can be converted into power.

The second way did not win because it was better at meeting human needs. It won because it was better at mobilizing violence. The cannon, the plague, the legal code, the boarding school, the structural adjustment program—these were the conversion tools of the Money God. The people who resisted were killed, or starved, or assimilated. The people who surrendered their old gods and learned to worship the new one were rewarded with a place in the colonial order, however subordinate.

The first way is not gone. It survived in the memories of the conquered, in the ceremonies that went underground, in the commons that persisted in the cracks of the enclosure, in the gift economies that re-emerge whenever disaster strikes and neighbors turn to each other because the market has failed them. It is the older way, and it is the way that will outlast the Money God, because the Money God requires infinite growth on a finite planet, and that is a demand the planet will eventually refuse.

But before we can reclaim what was lost, we must understand the full architecture of the god that was installed. We must see the priesthood, the temple, and the catechism. That is the work of the next chapter.

Chapter 3: The Priesthood and the Temple

Walk into a bank. Not your bank's app, not the website, but the physical building. The marble. The high ceilings. The hush, broken only by the rustle of paper and the low murmur of transactions conducted in tones usually reserved for churches. The tellers sit behind glass, or used to, like acolytes behind an iconostasis. The vault is deeper in, visible sometimes through a heavy door, a sanctuary within the sanctuary.

You are here to perform a ritual. You deposit your labor, transformed into numbers, into the care of the institution. Or you borrow, pledging your future labor against a sum you receive now. Or you seek advice on how to make your stored labor grow, a form of intercession performed by a priestly caste called financial advisors.

None of this feels like religion because it is the water we swim in. But step back, and the architecture of the Money

God's church becomes unmistakable.

The Priesthood

Every god needs its priests. They are the ones who interpret the sacred texts, administer the sacraments, and guard the boundary between the sacred and the profane. For the Money God, the priesthood is composed of economists, central bankers, financial advisors, and the vast apparatus of professionals who manage the flows of money.

The economist is the theologian. She explains why things are the way they are, using a vocabulary that sounds descriptive but is often prescriptive. The market is not a human construction, she tells us. It is a natural force, like gravity. Its outcomes are not choices; they are equilibria. To interfere is to cause distortion. To question its fundamental rationality is to reveal oneself as ignorant of the science.

This is theology dressed in mathematics. The equations are real; the models are often useful. But the assumption that market outcomes are inherently efficient, that growth is always good, that human beings are rational utility-maximizers—these are not empirical findings. They are articles of faith, and they are defended with the ferocity that articles of faith always command in their orthodox defenders.

The central banker is the high priest. He controls the money supply, sets interest rates, and speaks in a coded language that markets parse for hints of future action. His words can move trillions of dollars. His institution is deliberately insulated from democratic accountability, because the Money God cannot be subject to the whims of the uninitiated. The temple must be independent. The high priest must be free to make the sacrifices that the doctrine requires.

The financial advisor is the parish priest. She meets you in her office, looks at your numbers, and tells you how to arrange your life to maximize the growth of your stored labor. She speaks of risk tolerance and asset allocation, of compound interest and tax efficiency. She is often a kind person, genuinely trying to help. But her toolkit is entirely shaped by the assumptions of the Money God. She cannot advise you to work less and spend more time with your children, because that does not show up in the portfolio. She cannot advise you to withdraw your money from the fossil fuel economy, unless there is a green fund that promises competitive returns. Her job is to optimize your worship, not to question the god.

The Temple

The temple is the financial system itself: the banks, the stock exchanges, the bond markets, the currency markets, the entire global architecture through which money flows and multiplies.

The temple operates by a logic that would be recognized as insane if it were not so familiar. A bank takes in deposits—your stored labor—and lends out most of it. The money you deposited is no longer in the vault. It is in someone else's pocket, working somewhere else, generating interest that flows back to the bank. If all depositors asked for their money back at once, the bank would collapse. This is called fractional reserve banking, and it is perfectly legal. It is, in fact, the foundation of the modern economy.

What this means, in spiritual terms, is that the temple runs on faith. The money is not really there. It is a promise, and the promise is backed by other promises, and the whole edifice depends on everyone continuing to believe that the promises will be honored. When belief wavers—when there is a run on a bank, a sovereign debt crisis, a stock market crash—the priests rush in with emergency measures. Central banks lend to banks. Governments guarantee deposits. The faith is restored. The temple stands.

The stock market is the temple's most visible ritual space. Here, pieces of companies are traded in a continuous frenzy of buying and selling. The prices move based not only on what the companies are actually worth but on what traders believe other traders will believe the companies are worth. It is a hall of mirrors, and fortunes are made and lost on the reflections.

The most important thing about the temple is what it excludes. The health of a forest is not priced. The dignity of a worker is not priced, except insofar as it affects productivity. The grief of a community that has lost its land to a mine is not priced. These are externalities, in the theological vocabulary of the Money God. They are outside the temple. They do not count.

The compass, applied to the temple, yields a grim verdict. Feedback is structurally blocked. The investor who profits from deforestation never feels the heat of the sun on the cleared land. The bank that forecloses on a family never hears the children crying in the motel room. Curiosity about alternatives is punished. Anyone who seriously proposes an economy organized around sufficiency rather than growth, or commons rather than property, is dismissed as utopian, unrealistic, or dangerous. The vulnerable are systematically sacrificed. The poor pay higher interest rates. The displaced are offered thoughts and prayers. The non-human world is treated as a resource to be liquidated.

The Sacrament of Credit

Every religion has its central sacrament—the ritual through which the faithful participate most directly in the divine. For the Money God, the sacrament is credit.

When you take on debt, you are not merely borrowing money. You are pledging your future. You are saying: *I will work, I will produce, I will generate value, and a portion of that value will flow to the lender for as long as the debt remains.* The debt becomes a claim on your life, enforceable by law. If you fail to pay, the temple can take your home, your car, your wages. In some times and places, it could take your freedom, or your children.

Credit is the mechanism through which the Money God ensures compliance. The mortgage keeps you in the job you hate, because you need the income to pay the bank. The student loan keeps you hoping for a career that will justify the decades of payments. The credit card keeps you consuming, and the interest keeps you paying, and the cycle keeps the money flowing.

Debt is also the mechanism through which the Money God disciplines nations. The International Monetary Fund and the World Bank, those high temples of global finance, lend money to developing countries under conditions of structural adjustment. Cut public spending. Privatize state assets. Open your markets to foreign capital. The debt must be repaid, whatever the cost to the population. The children who die from lack of clean water because the water utility was privatized are externalities. The faith must be maintained.

The Catechism

Every religion teaches its children a catechism—a set of simple, memorable answers to the most important questions. The Money God's catechism is taught not in Sunday school but in every advertisement, every news report, every political speech, every conversation about the economy.

Question: What is the purpose of an economy? **Answer:** To grow.

Question: What is a good person? **Answer:** A productive person. One who works, earns, spends, and saves.

Question: What is a bad person? **Answer:** A lazy person. One who does not contribute to growth. One who takes without giving back.

Question: Why are some people poor? **Answer:** Because they made bad choices. Because they lack skills. Because they are not sufficiently productive.

Question: What is the solution to poverty? **Answer:** More growth. More jobs. More opportunity for the poor to become productive.

Question: Is there an alternative? **Answer:** There is no alternative.

This catechism is so deep in our bones that most of us cannot hear ourselves reciting it. It feels like common sense, not theology. But it is theology, and it is remarkably recent. For most of human history, the purpose of an economy was to meet human needs within the limits of a particular place. Productivity was valued, but not above all else. The poor were not blamed for their poverty; they were cared for, or at least acknowledged as a collective responsibility. Alternatives were everywhere, because every place had its own way of organizing exchange, its own customs of reciprocity and redistribution.

The catechism is the final victory of the Money God. It is the colonization of the interior. When the conquered internalize the conqueror's values, the conquest is complete. The prison no longer needs walls. The prisoner carries the walls within.

The Silence of the Temple

There is a moment, if you sit long enough in a bank lobby, when the silence becomes audible. It is the silence of all that is not spoken. The soil that is not mentioned. The labor that is not named. The communities that are not counted. The generations that are not consulted.

The temple is built on this silence. It is the silence beneath the numbers, the unsaid upon which the said depends. And the silence has a function. It is the fog, made material. As long as the silence holds, the worship continues undisturbed.

But the silence can be broken. Every time someone asks—*Where does this money go? Who does it harm? What else might be possible?*—a crack appears in the temple wall. The cracks are small, and the temple is vast. But it is not eternal. It was built by human hands, over centuries, for specific purposes. And what human hands have built, human hands can unbuild.

Chapter 4: The Dopamine Loop

The Money God does not rule by decree alone. It rules by rewiring your brain.

This is not a metaphor. The neuroscience is clear, and it is chilling. The same neural circuitry that drives addiction to cocaine, gambling, and social media is the circuitry that the Money God has learned to exploit with industrial precision. You are not merely a consumer making rational choices. You are an organism whose reward system has been hacked.

The Molecule of Wanting

Dopamine is often called the pleasure chemical. This is a mistake, and a revealing one. Dopamine is not about pleasure. It is about anticipation, wanting, the thrill of the chase. Pleasure itself is mediated by other chemicals—endorphins, serotonin—but dopamine is what gets you out of the chair and reaching for the thing you have not yet obtained.

The dopamine system is ancient. It evolved to motivate animals to seek food, mates, and safety. It is a wanting machine, and it works by creating a gap between expectation and fulfillment. When something is better than expected—a particularly sweet berry, an unusually receptive mate—dopamine spikes, and the brain learns: *Do that again. Seek that out. Remember the context.* When the reward is exactly as expected, dopamine stays flat. When it is worse than expected, dopamine crashes, and the brain learns avoidance.

This is a perfectly functional system in a world of scarce rewards. The problem is that we no longer live in that world. We live in a world that has been engineered to produce an infinite supply of almost-rewards, each one hitting the dopamine system with just enough unpredictability to keep it firing, never enough satisfaction to let it rest.

The Engineering of Desire

The consumer economy is not organized around meeting needs. It is organized around the perpetual generation of wanting. Needs are finite. You need a certain amount of food, shelter, warmth, and social connection. Once those are met, in a sane economy, you would have enough, and you would turn your attention to other things: relationship, creativity, rest, service, wonder.

But a sane economy does not grow at three percent a year forever. A sane economy does not generate quarterly returns for shareholders. So the Money God must manufacture desire. It must teach you to want what you do not need, and to want it in a way that never resolves into satisfaction.

Advertising is the obvious mechanism, but it is only the most visible layer. The design of products themselves—the intermittent variable rewards of a smartphone notification, the carefully engineered crunch of a potato chip, the "new and improved" version that renders last year's model subtly shameful—is a deeper layer. The architecture of everyday life—the zoning laws that make walking impossible and cars necessary, the erosion of public spaces that forces social life into commercial venues, the erosion of extended family that makes every need a purchase—is deeper still.

The result is a world in which you are constantly bathed in cues that trigger wanting, constantly in a state of mild dopamine activation, constantly reaching, and constantly finding that the reaching is more satisfying than the having. The reward of the purchase lasts hours or days. The wanting of the next purchase is already rising before the first one has faded. This is not an accident. It is the Money God's perfect machine.

The Hedonic Treadmill

Psychologists call it the hedonic treadmill. You run, you acquire, you achieve, and for a brief moment you feel a lift. Then the baseline resets. The new car becomes just the car. The new house becomes just the house. The promotion becomes just the job. You are back where you started, only now you need something else to get the same lift. And so you run again.

The treadmill is not a personal failure. It is a feature of the neural architecture, and the Money God has learned to exploit it with terrifying efficiency. Each purchase promises what it cannot deliver: an end to wanting. But the system is designed so that wanting can never end, because wanting is the fuel. A satisfied consumer is a use-less consumer. A contented citizen is a drag on GDP.

The language of the catechism reinforces the treadmill from the inside. You are told that your dissatisfaction is a sign that you need more: more money, more stuff, more status. You are not told that the dissatisfaction is inherent in the pursuit. You are not told that the treadmill is the problem. You are told to run faster.

The Shame of Scarcity

And if you cannot run fast enough—if you are poor, if you are sick, if you are worn down by the relentless competition—the Money God has a specific emotional tool for you. It is called shame.

In the Money God's theology, poverty is not a structural condition. It is a moral failing. The poor are lazy. They make bad choices. They lack ambition. They are a drain on the productive. This theology is recited in political speeches, in think-tank reports, in the quiet judgments that comfortable people make about those who are not comfortable. It is so pervasive that even the poor internalize it. They blame themselves for their poverty, even when the poverty is the predictable outcome of a system designed to concentrate wealth at the top.

Shame is the emotion that polices the catechism. If you are struggling, you are supposed to feel ashamed. If you need help, you are supposed to feel diminished. The shame keeps you from organizing with others who share your condition. It isolates you. It makes you complicit in your own suffering. And it drives you, if you can scrape together enough money, to buy things that signal that you are not poor—the branded clothes, the new phone, the elaborate wedding—because these purchases, however ruinous to your actual finances, briefly relieve the shame.

The Money God does not need to lock you up. Shame is a more effective prison, and it operates from the inside.

The Addiction and Its Withdrawal

I have been using the language of addiction deliberately. The neurochemistry is the same. The pattern of escalating doses, diminishing returns, and painful withdrawal is the same. The denial is the same. The shame is the same.

And like any addiction, recovery is possible, but it is not easy. It requires a period of withdrawal. You must allow yourself to feel the gap between the promise and the reality. You must sit with the wanting without immediately reaching for something to fill it. You must notice the shame without believing the story it tells about your worth. You must begin to disentangle your sense of self from your consumption patterns.

This is not an individual project, though it begins with individual awareness. It is a collective project of recovery. The Money God's hold on you is maintained by the fact that everyone around you is also worshipping. The addiction is social. The recovery must be social too. You need communities that practice a different relationship to the material world, that value sufficiency over accumulation, that honor care over competition, that remind each other, constantly, that the Money God is an idol and not the true ground of being.

The next chapter begins to map what such communities might look like—and what they have looked like, in the places where the older economic theologies survived the conquest.

Chapter 5: The Old Gods Are Not Dead

The Money God wants you to believe that its way is the only way. That before the market, there was only primitive subsistence. That the indigenous economies of reciprocity and redistribution were charming but impractical, suited to small bands of hunter-gatherers but hopelessly inadequate to the complexity of modern life. That any attempt to organize an economy around something other than accumulation is a fantasy, doomed to collapse into poverty and tyranny.

This is a lie, and it is a lie that must be told, because the truth threatens the god's monopoly on worship. The truth is that alternatives to the Money God have existed for most of human history, still exist in pockets around the world, and are being reinvented right now in the cracks of the global economy. They are not fantasies. They are living traditions, suppressed but never extinguished, and they carry the seeds of a different future.

The Gift Economy

Before money, there was the gift. Not the gift of charity, where the giver retains power and the receiver incurs debt. The gift in its original, pre-monetary sense. The gift that creates obligation but not extraction. The gift that circulates, that binds a community together through a web of mutual indebtedness that is not shameful but sacred.

Marcel Mauss, the French anthropologist who studied gift economies in the early twentieth century, identified three obligations that structure the gift: the obligation to give, the obligation to receive, and the obligation to reciprocate. To refuse a gift is to declare war. To accept without reciprocation is to become a dependent. The gift is not a transaction that terminates; it is a relationship that endures.

In a gift economy, wealth is not measured by what you have but by what you give. Status is not achieved by accumulation but by generosity. The person who gives the most is the person who is held in highest esteem. This is the opposite of the Money God's logic, and it is a logic that has organized human societies for tens of thousands of years.

The Pacific Northwest potlatch, which we encountered in the previous chapter, is one of the most elaborate expressions of the gift economy. But the pattern appears everywhere. The Kula ring of the Trobriand Islands, where shell necklaces and armbands circulate in opposite directions among island communities, building relationships that span hundreds of miles. The reciprocity networks of the Andean highlands, where families exchange labor, food, and ritual obligations in cycles that stretch across generations. The barn-raising traditions of settler communities on the North American frontier, where neighbors gathered to build a structure that no single family could erect alone, knowing that the favor would be returned when their own barn was needed.

These are not idle customs. They are sophisticated systems of mutual insurance, risk-sharing, and collective investment. They operate without banks, without interest, without the threat of foreclosure. They operate on the basis of relationship and memory. They work.

The Resilient Commons

Alongside the gift economy, and overlapping with it, stands the commons. The commons is not merely a resource held in common. It is a social system for governing a shared resource sustainably, over long periods of time, without privatizing it or having it destroyed by a central authority.

Elinor Ostrom, the political scientist who won a Nobel Prize for her work on the commons, studied hundreds of common-pool resources around the world: irrigation systems in Spain, fisheries in Maine, forests in Nepal, pastures in Switzerland. She found that communities regularly developed sophisticated rules for managing these resources, often lasting for centuries, without any external authority imposing top-down control.

The rules varied, but certain principles recurred. Clear boundaries: who is in the community and who is out. Rules that fit local conditions, not one-size-fits-all mandates. Participatory decision-making, so that the people affected by the rules have a voice in making them. Monitoring of behavior, often by the users themselves. Graduated sanctions for violations, starting small and escalating only for repeated offenders. Mechanisms for resolving conflict that are accessible and fair. And recognition of the community's right to organize by external authorities, rather than its suppression.

Where these principles are present, the commons thrives, often outperforming both private property and state management. Where they are absent—where external authorities impose rules from above, or where private interests are allowed to capture the resource—the commons degrades.

The Money God's theologians have long argued that common ownership leads to tragedy, because each individual has an incentive to overuse what everyone shares. Ostrom's work demonstrates that this is not a law of nature. It is a failure of governance. Communities can and do manage shared resources sustainably, as long as they are allowed to do so, and as long as the conditions for effective self-governance are met.

The Living Examples

These are not historical curiosities. Gift economies and commons persist across the contemporary world, often in the shadow of the Money God's temple, often unrecognized by its priesthood.

In many indigenous communities, the potlatch is not a museum piece; it is a living practice, revived after the ban was lifted, adapted to contemporary conditions, still performing its ancient functions of redistribution, recordkeeping, and the maintenance of community bonds. Alongside it, the potlatch's core principle—status through generosity—is being adapted into urban mutual aid networks, time banks, and other experiments in non-monetary exchange.

The commons, too, is alive and expanding. Community land trusts, pioneered by the civil rights movement in the American South and now spread to cities across the world, take land out of the speculative market and hold it in trust for community benefit. The land is never sold; the buildings on it are affordable in perpetuity. This is not a theoretical model; it is functioning, now, in hundreds of communities, and the Downtown Eastside of Vancouver—a neighborhood we will examine later in this book—has one of its own.

Open-source software is a digital commons, built by thousands of contributors who give their labor freely, not for profit but for the prestige of a well-crafted solution, the satisfaction of collaboration, and the belief that certain tools should belong to everyone. Wikipedia is a commons of knowledge, maintained by volunteers, now the largest reference work in human history. The Money God's priests said this could not work. It works.

Seed libraries, community gardens, cooperative housing, worker-owned businesses, credit unions, participatory budgeting, community-supported agriculture—these are not fringe experiments. They are the living tissue of an alternative economy, growing in the cracks of the dominant order, proving every day that the Money God's catechism is a lie.

The Pattern Beneath the Practices

What unites these diverse traditions is not a specific institutional form but a shared orientation toward the material world. It is the orientation captured by the compass: feedback, curiosity, protection.

In a gift economy, feedback is short. If you take without giving, the community knows. Your reputation suffers. The consequences of your selfishness return to you quickly. In a commons governed well, feedback is built into the monitoring systems, the graduated sanctions, the participatory decision-making. The community feels the effects of its rules and adjusts them as conditions change.

Curiosity is alive. These systems are not static. They adapt to new circumstances with remarkable flexibility, precisely because they are governed by the people closest to the resource, who can see what is happening and respond accordingly. No central planner is required.

Protection of the vulnerable is central. The potlatch ensured that no one starved while a chief hoarded blankets. The commons ensures that even the poorest members have access to grazing, fuel, or water. The gift economy ensures that those who cannot reciprocate immediately are not cast out; the obligation is held, temporarily, by the community as a whole.

The Money God's economy fails all three tests. The alternatives pass them. That is not an ideological judgment. It is a structural one.

The Remembering

The task before us is not to invent a new economics from scratch. It is to remember what was known before the conquest, and to adapt that memory to the conditions of a globally connected world.

This is not a romantic return to a pre-modern past. The gift economy and the commons were not utopias; they had their own pathologies, their own hierarchies, their own blind spots. But they were not fundamentally organized around the worship of accumulation. They did not treat the living world as dead material. They did not systematically sever feedback, kill curiosity, and sacrifice the vulnerable. They were, in these crucial respects, saner than what we have.

The Money God's conquest was not total. The old gods survived in the underground, in the memory of the dispossessed, in the practices that refused to die. They are re-emerging now, not because we have become enlightened, but because the Money God's rule is producing conditions that are increasingly unlivable for more and more people. When the temple fails to provide, people turn to each other. That turning is the oldest economic pattern we have.

The next chapter explores one such turning—a specific, contemporary example of what it looks like when a community begins to reclaim its economic sovereignty, in the heart of one of the wealthiest cities on earth.

Chapter 6: The Colander

Vancouver's Downtown Eastside is the poorest urban postal code in Canada. It is also one of the most studied, most reported-on, most intervened-in neighborhoods in the country. Government reports pile up. Funding announcements are made with regularity. Task forces are convened. Pilot projects are launched. Foundations, non-profits, and university researchers have made careers here. The neighborhood is saturated with helping institutions.

And nothing changes.

Walk through the Eastside on any given day. You will see people sleeping on the sidewalk, people injecting in alleys, people shuffling in the slow gait of the chronically underfed and overmedicated. You will see the SRO hotels—Single Room Occupancy dwellings, most built a century ago, where residents live in rooms the size of a prison cell, with shared bathrooms, no kitchens, and windows that do not open. You will hear noise from businesses that play music at volumes that would be illegal in any other neighborhood, and you will notice that no bylaw officer ever comes. You will see police parked outside harm reduction sites, their mere presence enough to deter the people who need those sites from approaching. In the summer, the rooms become uninhabitable, and residents spill onto the streets and into the parks, where they are periodically cleared by authorities and returned to the uninhabitable rooms. In the winter, the rooms are cold, and the same cycle repeats.

This is not a failure of policy. This is a system operating exactly as designed.

The Colander

Imagine a colander. You pour in water. The water drains through the holes and exits. The spaghetti stays.

The Downtown Eastside is a colander. The spaghetti is the people. They stay. The water is the money. It flows through.

Every year, hundreds of millions of dollars are poured into the neighborhood. Federal funds, provincial funds, municipal funds, foundation grants, private donations. The money goes to the landlords who own the SROs and collect monthly subsidies for rooms they do not maintain. It goes to the non-profits, whose staff draw salaries and whose directors build careers. It goes to the researchers, who secure grants to study the problem and publish papers that lead to more grants. It goes to the police, who are funded to manage the disorder that the conditions produce. It goes to the consultants, who are hired to write reports recommending the same approaches that have been failing for decades.

And the people stay. In the same rooms. In the same conditions. With the same outcomes.

This is the Money God's perfect machine. Suffering is a resource to be extracted, like oil or timber. The flow of money depends on the continuation of the suffering. If the suffering ended, the grants would end. The jobs would end. The careers would end. The reports would have nothing to report on. No one in the chain of funding is evil. They are simply responding to the incentives the system creates. And the incentives point toward the maintenance of misery, not its elimination.

The Noise as Weapon

Let me tell you about the noise.

In the Eastside, businesses are permitted to generate noise at levels that would be legally actionable anywhere else in the city. Cars park outside SROs with stereos blaring. Music thumps from storefronts for hours. The buildings are old; the walls are thin. There is no escape. There is no legal recourse. Calls to bylaw enforcement go unanswered. The assumption, unstated but operative, is that these residents do not deserve the same quiet enjoyment of their homes that other renters take for granted.

The noise is not an inconvenience. It is an aggression. It communicates, hour after hour, day after day: *Your comfort does not matter. Your sleep does not matter. Your presence here is conditional on your endurance of whatever we choose to impose.*

And because there is no recourse, because the loop is severed, because the complaint goes nowhere, the only responses available to the resident are endurance, escape to the park, or a fantasy of destruction. The fantasy is not psychopathology. It is the logical assessment of a situation in which every door is closed except the one that leads to violence.

The Environmental Programming

I have described, in my other work, a concept I call environmental social programming. The idea is simple: a system can produce behaviors in a population not by commanding them but by arranging the environment so that the behaviors become the most available response to the conditions. Then the system can point to those behaviors as evidence of the population's inherent dysfunction, and use that evidence to justify more control.

The Eastside operates this way with precision. Drugs are widely available, and the laws against them are selectively unenforced. The result is visible public drug use and visible public degradation. Media cameras capture the degradation. The public sees the images and concludes that the residents are addicts who have chosen their condition. The stereotype is confirmed. The control is justified. The colander keeps operating.

The neighborhood is also a Native-majority community, with a high concentration of Indigenous residents displaced from their territories by colonial policies. The stereotype of the "drunken Indian" or the "addicted Native" has been a staple of settler ideology for centuries. The Eastside does not challenge that stereotype. It physically produces it, in the bodies and behaviors of its residents, and then broadcasts it to a public that has been trained to see the result as the cause.

This is the Money God's colonialism, updated for the era of reconciliation. It does not need to use explicit force.

It does not need to pass laws banning indigenous ceremonies. It only needs to arrange the economic environment so that the indigenous population is concentrated in uninhabitable housing, denied legal recourse against aggression, exposed to a flood of drugs, and then punished for the predictable outcomes. The system produces the pathology and then uses the pathology to justify the system.

The Funding That Disappears

When something works—when a program actually reduces harm, builds community resilience, or helps people exit the cycle—it often loses its funding.

The Aboriginal Front Door Society, a drop-in center serving the neighborhood's Indigenous residents, was recently informed that its provincial funding was set to expire. The center serves hundreds of people daily, providing food, storage, and a culturally safe space to simply be. It is one of the few institutions in the neighborhood that is genuinely trusted by the community. And its funding was set to expire, the notice arriving in time for a symbolic coincidence with the National Day for Truth and Reconciliation.

This is not an accident. A program that works threatens the colander. If suffering actually decreases, the flow of money begins to look unnecessary. The jobs built on managing the suffering become precarious. The careers built on studying it lose their subject. The politicians built on promising to address it lose their issue. The colander defends itself, quietly, by starving the things that might make a genuine difference.

The Compass on the Ground

Run the three questions on the Eastside, and the answers are stark.

Feedback: Severed at every level. The landlord never feels the heat that drives the tenant into the street. The policymaker never hears the noise that keeps the resident awake. The funder never sits in the room that the funding has failed to improve.

Curiosity: Dead. The same approaches are repeated decade after decade, with the same results, and no one asks whether the approach itself might be structurally flawed. The question "What if we let the community govern its own resources?" is not on the table. It is not even in the room.

Protection of the vulnerable: Inverted. The vulnerable are the raw material that the colander processes, the suffering that animates the funding cycle, the canaries whose song is drowned out by the noise that is itself a weapon.

The Crack

But the Eastside is also home to a community land trust, established in 2020, that takes land out of the speculative market and holds it for community benefit. It is home to a network of Indigenous organizations, peer-run initiatives, and mutual aid networks that operate outside the colander's logic. It is home to people who, despite everything, continue to care for each other with a tenacity that the Money God cannot account for.

The next chapter explores what it might look like to build, in a place like this, an economy that does not worship accumulation. It draws on the oldest traditions of this land—the potlatch, the gift, the commons—and asks what it would mean to apply those traditions, in adapted form, to a twenty-first-century urban neighborhood. The Money God's machinery is not invincible. It is just what currently occupies the space. And space can be reclaimed.

Chapter 7: The Gift Returns

The potlatch was never just a ceremony. It was a complete economic operating system, refined over millennia, that organized production, distribution, and social status around a single principle: wealth is not what you keep but what you give away.

The Money God's theologians called this primitive. They could not see the sophistication beneath the surface. In a potlatch, every gift is witnessed, every debt recorded in social memory. The system coordinates labor, manages risk, provides for the vulnerable, and incentivizes contribution—all without banks, without interest, without the threat of foreclosure. It works because the loops are short. The giver sees the recipient. The recipient knows the giver. Reputation is the currency, and it circulates with every feast.

The question for our time is not whether we can recreate the potlatch in its original form. We cannot, and we should not try. The potlatch belonged to specific nations, in specific places, with specific ceremonial protocols that are not ours to borrow. The question is whether we can learn from its logic and build economies that embody the same principles in forms appropriate to our own contexts. Can we build an economy where giving confers more status than hoarding, where care is as visible as profit, where the community owns its own means of survival?

The answer is yes. The blueprints exist. The experiments are running. And they are working, in the cracks of the Money God's crumbling temple.

The Network of Cells

Imagine an economy not as a single, integrated machine but as a network of semi-autonomous communities. Each community—call it a cell—owns its own land, runs its own enterprises, and governs its own internal affairs. The cells trade with each other, cooperate on shared challenges, and learn from each other's successes and failures. But no cell controls another, and no central authority controls the whole.

This is not a utopian dream. It is the structure of many indigenous economies before colonization, and it is re-emerging today in the form of community land trusts, worker cooperatives, and mutual aid networks. The cell is the unit of survival. It is small enough that feedback loops can remain short—the people making decisions feel the consequences of those decisions directly. It is large enough to achieve economies of scale for things like housing, energy, and food production.

A cell that fails does not bring down the network. Its people may move to other cells, or the cell may reorganize and try again. The network builds resilience through diversity. Different cells try different approaches. The ones that work spread. The ones that fail are abandoned. This is evolution, not central planning. And it is how living systems have always organized themselves.

The Tip Economy

Inside a cell, the internal economy can be organized around a principle drawn directly from the potlatch: tips, not wages, as the primary mechanism for recognizing contribution.

Imagine that a portion of all community surplus—from land rents, from cooperative enterprise profits, from any source of collective wealth—is distributed to members in two forms. Half is ordinary spending money, equally allocated to every member as a basic income. The other half is “liftable tips”: tokens that cannot be spent by the person who receives them but must be gifted to someone else, at which point they become spendable for the recipient.

The tips cannot be hoarded. They must flow. Every month, each member must give away their tips to other members, and in doing so, they are forced to recognize contributions. The tips become a continuous, decentralized vote on who is contributing most to the community’s well-being. The caregiver who sits with a dying elder receives tips. The teenager who helps a neighbor learn to read receives tips. The person who organizes the community kitchen receives tips. The work that the Money God renders invisible—care, teaching, maintenance, emotional support—becomes the most visible work in the cell.

This is not a wage. It is not charity. It is a continuous, collective act of recognition. And it solves a problem that has bedeviled every attempt at building a more humane economy: how do you measure the value of care? You do not measure it. You let the community signal it, continuously, through the only mechanism that can capture the texture of lived contribution: gratitude in action.

The Community Land Trust

The foundation of a cell's autonomy is control over land. As long as land is a commodity, subject to speculative markets, the cell is vulnerable. Rents rise, people are displaced, and the community's careful architecture of mutual care dissolves under market pressure.

The community land trust is the tool that removes land from the market permanently. A trust, governed by community members, holds title to the land. It leases the buildings on the land to residents—for ninety-nine years, renewable, inheritable—at rates designed to cover costs, not to generate profit. The buildings can be bought and sold, but only at prices limited by a resale formula that keeps them affordable forever. The land is no longer an asset to be flipped. It is a home to be stewarded.

This model is not theoretical. It was pioneered by Black farmers in the American South during the civil rights movement, who needed a way to secure land against the economic retaliation that followed registration to vote. It now houses communities in cities from Burlington to London to Vancouver. And it is the anchor of any serious attempt to build an economy that worships life rather than accumulation.

The Sovereign Fund

A healthy cell does not merely meet its members' basic needs. It builds wealth collectively, so that the community can invest in its own future.

Imagine a community development bank, governed by its members, that captures local savings and directs them toward local needs. Instead of your money leaking out to a distant financial institution that invests it in fossil fuels and weapons, it stays in the community, financing affordable housing, renewable energy, worker-owned businesses, and care infrastructure. The interest you earn is modest, but the return to your community is enormous.

This is not a fantasy. It is how credit unions have operated for more than a century. It is how the JAK Members Bank in Sweden has provided interest-free loans to its members for decades. It is how the Bank of North Dakota, a publicly owned state bank, has kept credit flowing to farmers and small businesses while private banks have retrenched.

The cell does not need to invent these tools. It needs to adapt them, combine them, and embed them in a network of mutual obligation that the Money God cannot easily dissolve.

The Interface with the Outside

A cell does not seal itself off from the larger economy. It could not, even if it wanted to. It needs materials, knowledge, and goods that it cannot produce internally. And its members will always have connections to the world beyond its boundaries.

The cell trades with the outside, but it does so on terms that preserve its autonomy. It buys what it needs, sells what it produces, and participates in networks of solidarity with other cells. A common currency may facilitate this trade—perhaps a national currency like the Canadian dollar, perhaps a complementary currency designed for inter-cell exchange, perhaps both. The point is not to abandon money but to make money a servant, not a master. The Money God is not destroyed; it is demoted.

The cell is porous but not defenseless. It can choose to limit certain kinds of extraction. It can decide, for example, that no external corporation may buy land within its boundaries, or that certain resources are held in common and managed through Ostrom's principles. It can protect its internal gift economy from being swamped by the market, while still engaging with the market where engagement serves its members.

The Compass in the Cell

Look at the cell through the compass, and the design makes structural sense.

Feedback is short. The people who make decisions about resources are the people who live with the consequences of those decisions. The tip economy makes contribution visible and creates an immediate loop between service and recognition. The community land trust makes the cost of maintenance visible and creates an incentive to invest in the long-term health of the buildings and the land.

Curiosity is alive. Different cells try different approaches. The network evolves not through central command but through distributed experimentation. A cell that finds a better way to manage water or generate energy or support elders can share that knowledge with others. No one is forced to adopt it, but everyone can learn from it.

The vulnerable are protected. The tip economy rewards care. The land trust ensures housing is permanently affordable. The basic income floor ensures that no one starves or freezes, even if they are unable to contribute in ways the market would recognize. The cell treats its most fragile members not as burdens but as the voices that reveal where the system is failing.

The Cost of the Alternative

The Money God's priests will tell you that this is impossible. They will tell you that it is inefficient, that markets allocate resources better, that communities cannot govern themselves, that the potlatch was primitive, that the modern economy is the only way to produce prosperity.

Look around you at the prosperity the Money God has produced. Look at the burned forests. Look at the acidifying oceans. Look at the children working in cobalt mines. Look at the workers sleeping in their cars because they cannot afford rent on a full-time wage. Look at the loneliness, the despair, the rising tide of deaths from despair in the richest countries in human history.

Then ask yourself: inefficient compared to what?

The Money God's economy is not efficient. It is merely externalizing its costs so that the priesthood does not have to see them. The potlatch economy kept those costs visible and internal. The community land trust keeps housing affordable by design, not by subsidy. The tip economy recognizes care that the market ignores. The common currency stays in the community, reinvesting in the soil it came from.

The next chapter addresses the most urgent practical question: how do we begin to build this, now, in the communities where we actually live? The Money God will not yield its temple without a struggle. But the struggle is not a single battle. It is a thousand small acts of economic disobedience, each one a seed.

Chapter 8: The Exorcism Begins

The Money God is not a metaphor. It is a structure that lives in your habits, your relationships, your anxieties, and your sense of self. You cannot vote it out of office. You cannot wait for a revolution. You can only begin, in your own life and in your own community, to withdraw your worship and direct your energy toward something more alive.

This chapter is about the first steps. They are small. They are unglamorous. They will not make you feel heroic. But they are real, and they are available, and they work.

Start Where You Are

Look at your own economic life. Not with shame, but with curiosity. Shame is the Money God's tool; curiosity is yours. Ask: *Where does my money actually go?*

Trace one dollar. Pick a single recurring expense—rent, food, a subscription, a debt payment—and follow it as far as you can. Who receives it? What do they do with it? What does it fund, ultimately, at the end of the chain? You will hit fog. The chain will disappear into a bank, a holding company, a fund with an opaque name. That is normal. The fog is thick by design.

But even partial tracing will reveal something. You may discover that your pension fund owns shares in a company you would never knowingly support. You may discover that your rent payment services a mortgage held by a bank that finances fossil fuel extraction. You may discover that the cheap clothes you buy are cheap because someone, somewhere, was paid less than it costs to live.

Do not panic. Do not try to purify your entire life overnight. That way lies burnout and despair. Pick one thing. One dollar you can redirect. One purchase you can replace with a local alternative. One account you can move to a credit union. One debt you can begin to pay down more aggressively. One skill you can learn—cooking, mending, growing, repairing—that reduces your dependence on the Money God's supply chains.

The goal is not moral purity. The goal is reconnection. Each severed loop you restore, even partially, is a crack in the temple wall.

Join or Build a Cell

The Money God's economy is designed to keep you isolated. The isolated consumer is easier to manage than the connected citizen. The isolated worker is easier to exploit than the member of a cooperative. The isolated debtor is easier to shame than the participant in a mutual aid network.

So the second step is to find your people. Not a political party. Not an online community of outrage. A group of people, in your physical vicinity, with whom you can begin to build economic alternatives.

This might be a community garden. It might be a tool library. It might be a childcare cooperative. It might be a time bank, where you exchange hours of labor instead of dollars. It might be a group of neighbors who meet monthly to discuss how to support each other through job losses, illnesses, and the ordinary crises of life.

If nothing like this exists near you, start it. Start small. Three neighbors. One shared meal. One conversation about what you each need and what you each can offer. The potlatch began with a single gathering. The commons began with a single agreement. You do not need permission. You need only the willingness to begin.

The cell you build does not need to be perfect. It does not need to be ideologically pure. It needs only to be a space where the Money God's logic does not rule, where gifts can circulate, where care is recognized, where the loops are short enough that people can see the consequences of their choices and adjust.

The Threshold of Divestment

At some point, if you take this path seriously, you will encounter a question you have been avoiding. What do I do with the stuff I have accumulated? The savings, the investments, the property, the possessions that I do not need and that are, in many cases, extracting value from others while I sleep?

The old traditions have an answer. The potlatch required the chief to give away not just surplus but treasured possessions, including copper shields and blankets that represented generations of accumulated status. The Christian monastic tradition required vows of poverty. The Hindu renunciate gave away everything and walked the roads with a begging bowl. The threshold of divestment is ancient. It is the moment when you stop worshipping the idol by surrendering the tokens of its power.

I am not asking you to take a vow of poverty. I am asking you to consider what you actually need, and to begin releasing what you do not. The money you give away can seed a community land trust, fund a worker cooperative, support a mutual aid network, or simply help someone who is struggling. The possessions you release can find homes where they will be used. The investments you liquidate can be redirected toward enterprises that regenerate rather than extract.

This is not self-punishment. It is liberation. The Money God's hold on you is maintained by your fear of losing what you have. When you voluntarily release what you do not need, that hold weakens. You discover, viscerally, that your worth is not your net worth. You discover that the community can hold you when your private stores are gone.

Start small if you need to. Give away one significant possession. Liquidate one account and redirect the funds to something living. See how it feels. The fear is almost always worse than the act. And the act opens a door.

The Resistance You Will Meet

When you begin to withdraw your worship, expect resistance. Not from the Money God—the god is not a being with intentions—but from the structures and people whose power depends on the god's worship continuing.

Your bank will not make it easy to leave. The online interface will offer no option to close your account; you will have to call, to wait, to explain. The financial advisor will warn you that you are being irrational. The family member will tell you that you are being irresponsible, that you need to think about your future, that you are endangering your security.

Listen to these voices with compassion. They are afraid. They have been trained to believe that the Money God's temple is the only shelter from the storm. Their fear is real, and their love for you may be genuine. But do not let their fear become your chain.

You do not need to argue. You do not need to convert anyone. You need only to continue, quietly, building the alternative. The tree that bends in the wind does not need to defend itself against the gale. It roots deeper and continues to grow.

The Policy Ask

The Money God's temple is not only in our habits and relationships. It is also in the law. The zoning codes that make local food production illegal. The banking regulations that favor massive institutions over community lenders. The tax codes that reward speculation and punish labor. The trade agreements that privilege corporate rights over community sovereignty.

These must change. But I have been strategic in this book about what to ask for. I am not asking for a revolution that seizes the temple by force. I am not asking for a Great Reset that imposes a new blueprint from above. I am asking for something far simpler, and far harder to refuse.

Tolerance.

Allow communities that wish to organize differently to do so. Let them form community land trusts. Let them start local currencies. Let them operate worker cooperatives. Let them manage their own housing. Do not fund them if you do not want to. Do not promote them if you are not convinced. Simply stop blocking them with laws that were written by the Money God's priests to protect the temple's monopoly.

Tolerance is cheap. It costs the state nothing to allow a community to own its own land, operate its own enterprises, and govern its own internal economy. If the experiment fails, it fails locally. If it succeeds, it reduces the burden on public services and generates models that others can adapt.

This is not a threat to power. It is an offer. Give us the space to prove that another way is possible. If we fail, you lose nothing. If we succeed, everyone gains.

The Long View

You will not see the end of this story. The Money God's temple took five centuries to build. It will not be dismantled in a generation. The cells you help create may be fragile, temporary, incomplete. Some will fail. Some will be co-opted. Some will simply run out of energy and dissolve.

This is not defeat. This is evolution. The cells that survive and thrive will be the ones whose practices are most attuned to the needs of living systems. They will spread their patterns through imitation, not imposition. They will connect with each other, forming a network that grows denser and more resilient over time.

Your job is not to complete the work. It is to participate faithfully in the piece of it that is within your reach. To shorten the loops you can shorten. To build the relationships you can build. To release the attachments you can release. To plant seeds that may not sprout until after you are gone.

The exorcism is not an event. It is a practice. And it begins, every morning, with the small choice to worship something more alive than the idol in your pocket.

Chapter 9: The Great Unplugging

The Money God's temple appears monolithic, but it has a vulnerability it cannot defend against. It depends on our participation. Every dollar spent inside its walls, every hour of labor sold to its priests, every investment entrusted to its funds is a vote of confidence, a renewal of the worship. If enough people withdraw that participation—not all at once, not in a single revolutionary rupture, but steadily, in a thousand small defections—the temple begins to starve.

This chapter is about the collective dimension of that withdrawal. It is about how communities, not just individuals, can begin to unhook their economic lives from the Money God's machinery and plug into something they have built for themselves.

The Leakage Problem

Every community leaks. Money enters—through wages, benefits, pensions, grants—and most of it leaves almost immediately. It goes to distant landlords, to supermarket chains headquartered in another city, to banks that lend it out elsewhere, to utilities owned by shareholders who have never visited the town. The money flows into the community like water into a cracked bucket. The people stay poor, not because they lack resources, but because the resources do not stay.

This is the colander problem we saw in the Downtown Eastside, and it operates everywhere, in every community that the Money God has colonized. The solution is not to demand more money from the outside. It is to plug the holes. To create structures that capture the money that is already flowing through and redirect it into local circulation, where it can touch multiple hands before exiting, each touch creating value, each circuit strengthening the community's internal economy.

This is not autarky. It is not sealing the community off from the world. It is plugging the leaks and reducing the dependence on external systems that extract more than they return.

The Anchor Institution

Every resilient local economy needs an anchor. An institution that is rooted in place, that cannot move, that spends its money locally and draws other spending into the local orbit.

In the old economy, the anchor might have been a factory, a mine, a military base. But these anchors could leave when the Money God's calculations shifted. The factory moves to Mexico. The mine plays out. The base closes. The community that depended on them collapses.

The new anchors are different. They are institutions that the community owns and that cannot be moved by any external force. A hospital. A university. A community land trust. A municipally owned utility. A cooperative network of enterprises. These institutions spend their money locally—on wages, on supplies, on services—and that spending becomes the foundation of a local economic ecosystem.

The anchor institution is the cell's heart, pumping resources through the community's internal circulatory system. The stronger the anchor, the more money circulates locally before it exits. The more money circulates locally, the more enterprises can survive and grow. The more enterprises survive and grow, the more the community can meet its own needs from its own production. The loop strengthens.

The Multiplier Effect

Economists have a concept called the multiplier. When a dollar is spent in a local economy, it does not disappear. The person who receives it spends a portion of it, and the person who receives that spends a portion, and so on. The total economic activity generated by that single dollar depends on how many times it changes hands locally before it leaks out.

In a typical modern community, the multiplier is low—often less than two. A dollar of wages generates less than two dollars of total local economic activity. In a community with strong local institutions, local supply chains, and local ownership, the multiplier can be three, four, five, or more. The same dollar, circulating internally, generates far more wealth than a dollar that exits immediately to a distant corporation.

Building the multiplier is not a matter of protectionism or boycotts. It is a matter of creating local alternatives that are genuinely better—fresher food, more responsive services, more meaningful jobs—so that people choose local not out of grim duty but out of genuine preference. The community that builds a local food system that delivers better produce than the supermarket, a local credit union that treats its members better than the bank, a local energy cooperative that provides cheaper power than the utility, does not need to force anyone to buy local. People will choose to, because it is in their interest to do so.

The Sectoral Approach

No community can produce everything it needs. The goal is not autarky but strategic self-sufficiency in a few key sectors, combined with robust trade for everything else. The sectors that matter most are the ones that meet basic needs: food, housing, energy, water, care, and finance.

Every dollar a community spends on food that was grown thousands of miles away is a dollar that has exited the multiplier. Every dollar spent on food grown within the community, or within a network of neighboring communities, is a dollar that circulates. The community that invests in urban agriculture, community-supported agriculture, farmers' markets, food hubs, and local processing facilities is plugging a major leak.

Every dollar spent on rent that flows to a distant landlord is a dollar that has exited. Every dollar spent on a community land trust mortgage, where the payments stay within the trust and fund further affordable housing, is a dollar that circulates. The land trust is one of the most powerful tools for plugging the housing leak.

Every dollar spent on electricity from a shareholderowned utility is a dollar that leaves. Every dollar spent on electricity from a community-owned renewable energy cooperative is a dollar that stays, powering not just homes but the local economy itself.

Finance is the most important sector to reclaim, because finance is the multiplier's multiplier. A community bank or credit union that captures local deposits and lends them to local enterprises turns the savings of the community into the investment capital of the community, without the leakage of interest payments to distant shareholders. It keeps the money circulating, and it keeps the profits local.

The Solidarity Economy

No single cell can thrive in isolation. The cells must trade with each other, support each other, and learn from each other. This is the solidarity economy: a network of cells that recognize their mutual interdependence and build institutions to express it.

A group of cells might create a shared purchasing cooperative to buy in bulk and reduce costs. They might create a shared distribution network to move goods between cells efficiently. They might create a shared insurance pool to protect against the risks that no single cell can bear alone. They might create a shared currency—complementary to the national currency, not replacing it—to facilitate trade among themselves and to keep value circulating within the network.

The solidarity economy is not a state. It is not a corporation. It is a voluntary association of autonomous communities, bound together by mutual benefit and shared values. It grows organically, as cells discover each other and find reasons to cooperate. It does not require anyone's permission, and it cannot be easily captured by any single interest.

The Immune Response

The Money God's temple will not ignore these developments forever. As cells grow stronger and more numerous, they will begin to threaten the revenue streams that sustain the old order. The temple has an immune response, and it will deploy it.

The first response is ridicule. Local food is elitist. Cooperatives are inefficient. Community currencies are play money. The ridicule is designed to discourage participation by making it seem foolish or marginal.

The second response is regulatory pressure. Zoning laws are used to block urban agriculture. Health codes are used to shut down community kitchens. Banking regulations are used to strangle credit unions and local currencies. The regulatory system was written by the Money God's priests, and it can be wielded against those who threaten its power.

The third response is co-optation. The temple absorbs the language and aesthetics of the alternative economy while hollowing out its substance. The bank launches a "local investment" fund that funnels money to the same old extractive industries. The supermarket chain creates a "local" brand that sources from industrial farms five hundred miles away. The developer adopts the language of community land trusts while building luxury condos that displace the very people the trust was meant to protect.

The fourth response, when all else fails, is force. The community that refuses to sell its land for a pipeline faces expropriation. The cooperative that competes too successfully with a corporate rival faces a predatory lawsuit. The leader who articulates the alternative too compellingly faces criminal charges, or worse.

None of this is speculation. It is the historical record of what happens when people build economic alternatives that genuinely threaten the Money God's reign. The cells that survive are the ones that anticipate the immune response and prepare for it—legally, politically, culturally, and in their internal resilience.

The Compass in the Movement

The solidarity economy, like any human enterprise, can become sick. It can replicate the very patterns it was meant to escape. The cells can develop their own hierarchies, their own orthodoxies, their own ways of silencing the vulnerable.

The compass is the movement's immune system against its own corruption. Every cell, and the network as a whole, must continually ask: *Is feedback flowing? Are the people most affected by our decisions able to influence those decisions? Is curiosity alive? Are we learning from our failures, or are we defending our ideology against uncomfortable evidence? Are the vulnerable protected? Are the poor, the marginalized, the exhausted, the canaries within our own community heard and honored, or are they being sacrificed to the needs of the institution?*

A movement that asks these questions honestly and acts on the answers will be resilient and adaptive. A movement that stops asking them will become what it set out to replace—a new temple, with new priests, worshipping a slightly updated version of the same idol.

The Great Unplugging

The Money God's temple was built over centuries, brick by brick, law by law, habit by habit. It will not be dismantled in a single dramatic confrontation. It will be abandoned, gradually, as more people discover that they can live without it, that life outside its walls is not only possible but more satisfying, more connected, more human.

Each cell that forms is an unplugging. Each dollar redirected is an unplugging. Each gift that circulates outside the market is an unplugging. Each piece of land removed from speculation is an unplugging. Each worker who becomes an owner is an unplugging. Each community that learns to meet more of its own needs from its own resources is an unplugging.

The unplugging is not a single event. It is a cascade. And like all cascades, it begins slowly, invisibly, until a threshold is crossed and the landscape changes with what seems like suddenness but was actually decades in the making.

You may not see the threshold crossed. You are planting seeds for a forest you will not walk in. But the planting is the work, and the planting is enough.

Chapter 10: The Fountain and the Idol

We began with a cup of coffee. We traced its hidden history—the soil, the hands, the ships, the silence that descends between producer and consumer. We saw that this silence is not accidental. It is the Money God's primary sacrament: the severing of feedback, the erasure of relationship, the transformation of a living world into dead commodities that arrive in our hands as if from nowhere.

We have traveled through the temple. We have met its priests, learned its catechism, felt the dopamine loop tightening in our own brains. We have seen the alternatives that were suppressed—the potlatch, the commons, the gift—and the alternatives that are re-emerging now, in the cracks of the old order. We have examined the colander of the Downtown Eastside, where suffering is a resource to be extracted, and we have seen the seeds of a different economy being planted in that same soil.

Now, at the end, I want to return to the beginning. Not the beginning of the book, but the beginning of everything. The fountain.

The Two Theologies

There are two ways to understand the material world, and they have been at war for as long as human beings have walked the earth.

The first way, the older way, sees the world as alive. The land is not a resource but a relative. The gift is the primary form of exchange, and the gift creates relationship, and relationship creates obligation, and obligation weaves the community into a fabric that can hold everyone. Wealth is what circulates. Status belongs to the generous. Enough is a sacred word.

The second way, the way of the Money God, sees the world as dead. The land is property. Value is price. Exchange is transaction, and transaction terminates, and termination means that no ongoing obligation survives the moment of purchase. Wealth is what accumulates. Status belongs to the hoarder. Enough is a heresy, because the system must grow, forever, on a planet that is not growing.

The first way is not utopian. It has its own pathologies, its own blind spots, its own histories of exclusion and violence. But it is fundamentally oriented toward life. It keeps feedback loops short. It allows curiosity about different forms of exchange and relationship. It treats the vulnerable as sensors whose distress signals the health of the whole.

The second way is not entirely evil. It has produced extraordinary material abundance, liberated millions from grinding subsistence, funded art and science and medicine on a scale the old ways could never have achieved. But it is fundamentally oriented toward extraction. It severs feedback loops to protect the powerful from the consequences of their decisions. It punishes curiosity about alternatives, because alternatives threaten the monopoly. It sacrifices the vulnerable systematically, because the vulnerable are not profitable.

The question is not whether the Money God can be reformed. The question is whether we can transfer our worship to something more alive, while retaining what was genuinely valuable in the Money God's reign.

The Fountain

In the cosmology that underlies this work, there is an image that returns to me when I need to remember what this is all for.

Before time, there was only Chaos: pure potential, infinite possibility, the unformed dark that holds every world that might ever exist but has not yet become actual. And then Light pressed into Chaos. Not to destroy it, but to dance with it. At the edge where they meet, things become real. Galaxies, mountains, forests, children, cups of coffee, songs, griefs, loves. All of it happens at the boundary between order and possibility.

The Light is not a king on a throne. It is a fountain. It pours outward endlessly, not because it lacks anything, but because overflowing is its nature. It is curiosity made cosmic. It wants to see what will happen. It wants to discover what forms will emerge when order meets chaos and something new crystallizes at the edge.

We are the probes of that fountain. Each of us is a place where the Light is experiencing itself, learning about itself, expanding its own capacity to imagine. When we create, when we connect, when we care for each other, when we receive gifts and pass them on, we are participating in the fountain's endless, generous overflow.

The Money God is a frozen image of the fountain. It takes the endless flow and tries to capture it in a token, to accumulate it, to hoard it. It mistakes the token for the flow. It worships the bucket and forgets the spring. The potlatch, the commons, the gift—these are older ways of participating in the fountain directly, without the bucket, without the hoarding, without the frozen idol that must be defended against all comers.

The Compass Is the Fountain's Logic

The three-point compass is not an arbitrary set of rules. It is a description of how the fountain operates in any healthy system.

Feedback is the fountain's sensitivity. The Light does not impose a blueprint from above. It pushes into Chaos, feels the response, adjusts, pushes again. Creation is a conversation, not a decree. A system that severs feedback is a system that has stopped participating in the fountain. It has become an idol, frozen and brittle.

Curiosity is the fountain's engine. The Light does not know in advance what will emerge. It is genuinely interested. It wants to see. A system that suppresses curiosity is a system that has stopped being part of the fountain. It has decided that it already knows everything, and nothing new can be born.

Protection of the vulnerable is the fountain's intelligence. The most sensitive parts of any system are where disruption registers first. The Light listens to those parts, adjusts accordingly, and in doing so keeps the whole system alive. A system that crushes its canaries is a system that has lost the capacity to feel its own damage. It will not survive.

The Economy of the Fountain

What would an economy look like if it were organized around the fountain rather than the idol?

It would look like the cells we described. Communities that hold land in trust, removing it from speculation. Enterprises owned by the people who work in them. Banks that capture local savings and reinvest them locally. Care work recognized through the continuous circulation of gifts and tips. A floor of sufficiency so that no one is desperate enough to accept exploitation. A ceiling of consumption so that the planet's limits are honored.

It would look like the solidarity economy. Cells trading with each other, learning from each other, supporting each other through hardship, competing not for market share but for excellence in service and innovation in meeting needs.

It would look like the potlatch, adapted to a digital age. Status flowing to the generous. Wealth measured by what is given, not what is kept. The community as the unit of meaning, the gift as the primary transaction, the relationship as the enduring wealth.

It would not look like a blueprint. It would look like a garden. Tended. Adaptive. Diverse. Always changing, always learning, always returning to the fountain for renewal.

The Idol's End

The Money God is not eternal. It was built by human hands, for specific historical purposes, and those purposes are now consuming the conditions that made the god possible. Infinite growth on a finite planet is a physical impossibility. The only question is whether the transition away from the god is managed with some measure of wisdom and compassion, or whether the god collapses catastrophically, taking much of the living world with it.

The cells and networks described in this book are not a guarantee against catastrophe. They are an insurance policy. They are the seed bank for a post-Money God civilization. If the temple collapses suddenly, the communities that have already learned to feed themselves, house themselves, finance themselves, and care for each other without the temple's scaffolding will be the communities that survive and become the seeds of whatever comes next.

If the temple does not collapse suddenly—if it winds down, gradually, as more and more people withdraw their participation—those communities will be the laboratories in which the new economy is developed and proven. They will be the demonstration projects that show, to a skeptical world, that life after the Money God is not only possible but better.

The Next Step

You are at the end of this book. You have a diagnosis and a direction. You have a compass. You have examples of what the alternative looks like in practice. You have an invitation.

The next step is not to read another book. It is to begin. Start where you are. Trace one dollar. Join or build one cell. Release one attachment. Plant one seed. The Money God's power over you is real, but it is not absolute. It depends on your continued participation. And every time you redirect that participation toward something more alive, the idol weakens and the fountain flows a little more freely in the world.

The fog is not permanent. The temple is not forever. The old gods are not dead. And the fountain is still flowing, through you, through everyone, through the endless generosity that is the deepest structure of reality.

Go now. The work is waiting. And you are ready to begin.

End of The Money God.